sprout

SPROUT 2.0 / NEWTONITE ASSIGNMENT

A clearer path to the first investment.

Reducing uncertainty from the homepage through identity verification.

A case study in reasoning with incomplete data, balancing stakeholder requests and designing for first-time investors in India.

THE APPROACH

Prepare before asking. Explain while verifying. Make waiting understandable.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Downloads are not becoming first investments.

The brief establishes a conversion problem. Its causes still need investigation.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

First-time investors need a clearer path from understanding Sprout to preparing for and completing KYC, so they can decide whether to take the next step with fewer avoidable uncertainties.

The evidence

Sprout reports 40,000 downloads, 9,000 completed KYC checks and 3,000 first investments. Support reports two recurring themes: users lack PAN / Aadhaar when asked, and the waiting screen appears to have crashed.

The working hypothesis

Unexpected document requirements and unclear verification feedback may contribute to abandonment. These signals justify investigation; they do not prove the causes of every drop-off or establish users' investment intent.

The design objective

Connect the homepage and five onboarding screens through consistent language, early preparation and clear status feedback. Prioritize mobile, given the reported 91% mobile share, within the three-week, one-developer constraint.

Evidence status: this is a design proposal based on the supplied brief and advisory. No interviews, usability studies, production measurements or conversion uplift are claimed.

01 / FUNNEL ANALYSIS

The largest loss is before completed KYC.

Calculations assume comparable users and observation windows. Confirm cohort definitions before using these as operational baselines.

40,000
Downloads / 100%

9,000
Completed KYC / 22.5% of downloads

3,000
First investments / 7.5% of downloads

Download → completed KYC

9,000 / 40,000 = 22.5% conversion. The remaining 31,000 represent a 77.5% loss. This is the largest absolute gap, making preparation and verification the first area to investigate.

Completed KYC → first investment

3,000 / 9,000 = 33.3% conversion and 66.7% loss. The 6,000 users who completed KYC but did not invest need separate research into investment selection and decision-making.

Keep the measures separate: the reported 62% KYC-step drop-off has no defined denominator or period. It is not the 77.5% download-to-KYC loss. Verification waiting also precedes KYC completion.

02 / DATA AUDIT

Use the signals. Question the certainty.

The brief supplies useful direction, but no analytics definitions, research instrument or underlying dataset.

40k downloads / 9k KYC / 3k investments

Use provisionally for funnel arithmetic. Confirm the cohort, time window and attribution before evaluating change.

78% homepage bounce

Question generalizability: two weeks include paid traffic. Segment by source and device; do not assume organic bounce is lower.

62% KYC drop-off

Question the meaning: step boundaries, denominator and cause are unknown. Instrument starts, submissions, failures and completions.

91% mobile / 40% phones below Rs. 10,000

Use directionally to prioritize mobile and budget devices. Confirm sample coverage and what the 40% denominator represents.

6.2-second load on 4G

Treat as a performance warning. Re-measure with a named metric, device, network profile and percentile.

65% feel investing is scary / n=40

Existing-user sample excludes abandoners. Explore anxiety as a hypothesis; do not generalize to all prospective users.

“Many” prefer Hindi / regional content

No count or language breakdown. The brief does not link this claim to the n=40 survey. Prepare for localization, then validate demand.

Support evidence: document surprise and ambiguous waiting are actionable clues, but their frequency is unknown. Use them to frame research rather than quantify causes.

03 / PERSONAS

Two provisional user needs to design around

These proto-personas are hypotheses, not research-backed audience segments. They may overlap in the same person.

01 / The unprepared beginner

Context: a first-time investor exploring a small amount on a budget Android phone.

Goal: understand what is required before committing time or sharing identity details.

Possible friction: documents are unavailable, connectivity is inconsistent, and KYC requirements arrive unexpectedly.

Design response: show prerequisites early, explain why details are needed and offer a clear way to return later.

02 / The uncertain verifier

Context: a beginner who has submitted details and is waiting for verification; may prefer reading in Hindi.

Goal: know whether the request succeeded and what to do next.

Possible friction: a silent waiting state resembles a frozen app; unclear language increases uncertainty.

Design response: confirm receipt, name the pending state and explain return or notification options.

Research needed: speak to people who abandoned before and during KYC. Include budget-phone and Hindi-preferring users; test whether these needs actually explain their experience.

03 / JOURNEY MAP

One story from discovery to decision

Emotions and friction below are proposed research hypotheses. The journey extends beyond the five-screen design scope.

01 / Discover Curious: “Is this for me?”	Match the acquisition message, explain the starting amount and disclose investment risk.
02 / Open the app Interested: “What happens next?”	Repeat the homepage promise and visual tone; introduce one clear next step.
03 / Prepare Unprepared: “What do I need?”	List PAN, Aadhaar and linked mobile before requesting personal data; allow a later return.
04 / Verify Cautious: “Why these details?”	Explain purpose, use labelled fields and preserve valid progress through errors.
05 / Wait Uncertain: “Did it work?”	Confirm submission, show pending status and explain whether the user needs to stay.
06 / Explore and invest Deliberate: “Which option suits me?”	After approval, explain choices and support review before confirmation. Research this stage separately.

Success signals: users understand the offer, identify prerequisites, recover from errors and explain their verification status. A first investment remains a separate downstream outcome.

04 / STAKEHOLDER DECISIONS

Make the trade-offs explicit

Prioritize clarity and feasibility rather than accommodating every request in the launch experience.

CEO / Preserve a premium tone

Use a restrained geometric sprout as a guide, without a face or comic behavior. This reconciles the mascot requirement with minimalism; whether it feels trustworthy remains a research question.

Marketing / Keep a focused first release

Keep the mascot; defer video, live ticker, pop-ups and referral promotion. A single CTA and fewer assets protect attention and the page budget. Revisit referral placement after the first investment.

Compliance / Integrate the risk disclosure

Honor the brief's 12px minimum and first-viewport visibility wherever investment content appears. Have the final copy approved. Do not invent registration badges or claims about returns.

Development / Reuse simple components

Use shared inputs, buttons and status cards with an SVG mascot. Any CSS / Lottie animation must fit the under-100 KB constraint; total page weight must stay below 1.5 MB. Validate actual sizes.

Support / Explain preparation and waiting

Put the document checklist on the homepage and onboarding screen 2. Confirm submitted / pending / action-required states. The extra preparation step may introduce friction, so test it.

05 / HOMEPAGE RATIONALE

Explain the commitment before the action

Mobile and desktop should carry the same message and content priorities, adapted to their available space.

Hero: one promise, one primary action

Use “Start small. Learn as you grow.” with the Rs. 100 entry point and one “Get started” CTA. State that the user will continue in the app. Avoid implying an investment outcome or adding competing promotional banners.

Risk and trust: visible, factual information

Place the brief-required risk disclaimer in the first viewport at 12px or larger. Provide clear process explanations and only verified business information. A registration badge is not justified by the supplied material.

Preparation: reduce document surprise

Explain the journey in three steps: prepare, verify, explore. Include PAN, Aadhaar and linked mobile in a checklist. Use FAQs to answer why KYC is requested and how to return later.

Responsive behavior: preserve the hierarchy

Start at 360–390px widths. On desktop, use a two-column hero while retaining the same CTA and disclosure. Test short viewports, 16px mobile body text, 44px minimum targets, contrast and longer Hindi strings.

05 / ONBOARDING RATIONALE

Welcome, prepare, then verify the number

Each screen has one job. The sequence is a proposal to test, not evidence of improved conversion.

01 / Welcome

Decision: repeat the homepage message, use the same restrained guide and offer one primary next step. Show investment risk alongside the Rs. 100 message.

Reason: recognition reduces the discontinuity between website and app.

Validate: can users explain the offer and next step? Keep English active at launch; prepare the layout for Hindi rather than implying that it is already available.

02 / What you will need

Decision: show PAN, Aadhaar and linked mobile before data entry; allow users to return later.

Reason: this addresses the support theme of unexpected requirements.

Validate: does preparation improve readiness without creating an unnecessary barrier? Do not claim a five-minute duration without operational evidence.

03 / Mobile number and OTP

Decision: provide labelled input, send / resend states, number correction and specific error feedback. Retain valid input during recovery.

Reason: reduce avoidable re-entry and make interrupted sessions recoverable.

Validate: can users handle an expired code or wrong number without assistance? Use large controls and support paste / autofill where available.

05 / ONBOARDING RATIONALE

Explain verification. Make waiting legible.

Status should communicate a meaningful system state, not an invented percentage or a decorative loading loop.

04 / Identity verification

Decision: explain why identity details are requested, show the current step and provide contextual help. Confirm PAN entry and the approved Aadhaar provider flow with the product team before implementation.

Reason: users need purpose and recovery guidance while sharing sensitive information.

Validate: can users explain the request, review consent and correct an error? Additional provider sub-steps may be necessary; five key screens do not define the full integration.

05 / Verification status

Decision: show “Request received” and “Pending verification,” with a clear return or status-check action. Show an expected duration only when supported by provider data. Offer notifications only when the service exists.

Reason: explicit receipt and status address the complaint that waiting looks like a crash.

Validate: do users know whether submission succeeded and whether they can leave? Distinguish pending, approved, delayed and action-required states.

Recovery rule: explain an offline state and offer Retry without duplicate submission. Preserve permitted progress; name any field needing correction. Text must convey status even when motion is disabled.

06 / SUCCESS METRICS

Measure progress without inventing uplift

Use the counts as provisional reference points. Establish comparable cohorts before choosing numerical improvement targets.

Download → completed KYC

Unique users completing KYC within 14 days / attributable downloads in the same cohort.

Reference: 22.5%; supplied counts have no defined window.

KYC start → completion

Unique completions within 7 days of starting / unique KYC starters.

Baseline unknown; do not substitute the unexplained 62%.

Download → first investment

Unique first investments within 30 days / attributable downloads in the same cohort.

Reference: 7.5%; reconfirm with the proposed window.

Time to first investment

Median and p90 from first app open to first investment, alongside the 30-day non-conversion rate.

Baseline unknown. Reporting only converters hides abandonment.

Waiting-related support

Waiting / frozen-app contacts within 7 days per 100 KYC submissions in each cohort.

Establish before launch; use alongside status comprehension.

Guardrails: validation errors, repeat submissions, risk comprehension and page performance. Segment by source and device. Instrument events without collecting PAN, Aadhaar or OTP values.

07 / WHAT TO TEST NEXT

Learn first. Experiment with a clear question.

Prioritize the two support themes, then validate accessibility and performance on the intended devices.

1 / Research the abandonment

Speak to users who left before and during KYC. Ask what they expected, where they stopped and what prevented continuation. Use an optional two-question exit survey to broaden the signal; account for non-response bias.

2 / Test comprehension and recovery

Run 5–8 moderated sessions with budget-phone and Hindi-preferring beginners using fictional documents. Check prerequisite recall, OTP recovery, risk understanding and pending-state comprehension. Findings are directional, not population estimates.

3 / Compare verification wait screens

Randomize eligible users between the current experience and clearer receipt / status / next-action messaging. Primary outcome: KYC completion within 7 days of submission. Track waiting-related contacts and duplicate submissions. Set sample size and duration from baseline traffic before starting.

4 / Check inclusion and delivery constraints

Test budget Android devices on documented 4G conditions, keyboard and screen-reader use, AA contrast, 44px targets and 200% text zoom. Test real Hindi translations; 30% expansion is a planning allowance, not proof of fit. Measure the <1.5 MB page limit.